

# EMMA RACKSTRAW

[www.emmarackstraw.com](http://www.emmarackstraw.com)

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## PERSONAL INFORMATION

Email: [emma.rackstraw@gmail.com](mailto:emma.rackstraw@gmail.com)

Citizenship: USA

## ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

- Assistant Professor of Economics, Swarthmore College, August 2024-  
– On Leave AY2024-5
- SSRC Criminal Justice Innovation Postdoctoral Fellow, Quattrone Center at UPenn Carey Law, AY2024-5

## EDUCATION

- Harvard University, Ph.D. in Public Policy (Economics Track), 2024
- Wellesley College, B.A. in Economics (Major) and Music (Minor), 2014

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor economics, economics of crime, experimental economics, behavioral economics, economics of discrimination

## WORKING PAPERS

- When Reality TV Creates Reality: How “Copaganda” Affects Police, Communities, and Viewers. Available at [SSRN](#).
- Bias-Motivated Updating in the Labor Market. Available at [SSRN](#).

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

- Background Check Adjudication & Fair Chance Hiring. (with Amanda Agan & David Autor)
- Sticky Stereotypes: Inaccurate Beliefs and Observability. (with Anna Gifty Opoku-Agyeman)

## FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

- 2025: J-PAL Social Policy Research Initiative\*, Russell Sage Foundation\*
- 2024: Center for Black Entrepreneurship Research Fellowship\*
- 2023: Program in Criminal Justice Grantee, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy Research Grantee, Institute for Quantitative Social Science Grantee, Academy of Management Doctoral Consortium Scholarship, Women and Public Policy Program Grantee\*
- 2021: ReSTAT Research Grantee, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative Grantee
- 2020: HKS Wiener Center for Social Policy Pilot Grantee; Peggy Howard Fellowship for Graduate Study in Economics; Radcliffe Engaged Summer Grantee

- 2019: National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program
- 2014: Natalie Bolton Faculty Prize in International Economics; Phi Beta Kappa

\*Co-author PI

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Invited Seminars:

- 2025: Lafayette College
- 2024: Minneapolis Fed Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Initiative (OIGI), Penn Criminology Colloquium, Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE)
- 2023: HKS Economics and Social Policy, Wellesley Initiative for Scholars of Economics (WISE)

External Conferences and Workshops:

- 2025: Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars (Co-Organizer), Quattrone Center Spring Symposium, American Economic Association Meeting (AEA)
- 2024: Society of Labor Economists (SOLE)\*, Liberal Arts College Public & Labor (LAC-PaL), National Bureau of Economic Research Summer Institute (NBERSI), SABE-IAREP, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (TWECE)\*, PPE Society, American Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)\*
- 2023: AEA, Western Economic Association International Meeting (WEAI), NBERSI, Academy of Management Meeting (AoM), APPAM
- 2022: Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxECW)
- 2019: Association of American Law Schools (AALS)
- 2018: APPAM

\*Co-Author Presenting

Referee Service: Quarterly Journal of Economics, The Review of Economics Statistics, Journal of Public Economics, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Justice Quarterly, Journal of Criminal Justice.

## TEACHING

Teaching Interests: Econometrics, Labor Economics, Microeconomics, Experimental Economics, Academic Writing, Causal Inference, Discrimination, Behavioral Economics

Teaching Experience:

- Empirical Methods II for MPPs, Harvard Kennedy School, 2021
- Evaluation Course for Chief Evaluation Officers, Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
- Executive Education Course in Randomized Evaluation, J-PAL at MIT, 2019
- Econometrics for Undergraduates, Wellesley College, 2013

## PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT

- Research Assistant for Will Dobbie, Harvard Kennedy School, 2019 - 2022
  - Provided research assistance for criminal justice and discrimination related projects and courses
- Research Consultant
  - PDQuery (unpaid), 2022-present
  - Crime and Justice Policy Lab, University of Pennsylvania, 2021-present
  - Everytown for Gun Safety, 2018-19
- Associate Fellow (Academic IPA), Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
  - Designed curriculum on research methods and evaluation
- Senior Policy Associate, J-PAL North America at MIT, 2016 - 2019
  - Led Crime and Political Economy & Governance sectors
- Research Economist, Council of Economic Advisers, 2014 - 2016
  - Provided economic analysis in labor and education policy

## SKILLS

**Data & Software:** Stata (Advanced), R (Proficient), L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X(Proficient), Zotero (Proficient), Excel (Proficient), Python (Basic)

**Languages:** English (Native), French (Proficient), Spanish (Basic)

**Talents:** Singing (Semi-Professional), Glassblowing (Amateur)

## SERVICE

**Professional Service:** Kennedy School PhD Students' Association President (2021-2022), PhD Peer Mentor (2020-present), HKS Anti-Racism in Economics Founding Member (2020-2022), Organizer of Economics of Discrimination Reading Group (2020-2021)

**Community Service:** Providence Animal Center (2025-present), Morris Animal Refuge Volunteer (2022-2025), Prison Volunteer in MA DOC (2017-2020) and PA DOC (2022-present), Meals on Wheels Volunteer (2020-2023)